

SENDKIT DOCS

How warm-up improves your email health

Warm-up is the single biggest factor in whether your cold email reaches inboxes. Here is what it actually does, why the first two weeks decide everything, and how to read the health score.

What warm-up actually does

A brand new mailbox has no reputation with Gmail, Outlook, or any other provider. Warm-up earns one before it ever touches a prospect: a slow, steady exchange of real emails between real mailboxes, not fake traffic. Providers watch how those emails are sent, opened, replied to, and moved out of spam, and that consistent behavior builds trust the way a new employee does, slowly. Skip it, and your first campaign trains Gmail and Outlook to flag you as spam.

The two-week window

Warm-up takes about two weeks, and there is no shortcut; any tool claiming instant warm-up is warming the label, not the reputation. Volume is not a fixed schedule. A new mailbox sends just 3 to 4 warm-up emails on day one, then ramps as the health score climbs, up to around 25 a day for Google mailboxes and 20 to 25 for Microsoft. Azure mailboxes start at 1 a day on purpose, because Microsoft's sending limits are tighter and pushing early backfires faster. Warm-up runs every day including weekends, because reputation building does not pause.

How the health score works

Every mailbox gets a health score based on how its warm-up emails are actually landing, inbox versus spam, and how they are treated once they arrive. It is not a countdown timer or a number designed to reassure, which is why it climbs slowly instead of showing 100 on day one. It typically reaches the mid-90s after the full two weeks of consistent, clean sending, and if a warm-up email lands in spam, you see it, so you know whether to slow down or rotate the domain.

Ready to send

A health score of 96 and at least 14 days of warm-up. Both conditions matter; an early high score is not established reputation yet.

Pause and recover

Below a score of 95, stop cold sending until it recovers. A low-health mailbox drags its own reputation further and can spill over to other mailboxes on the domain. Above 95 you are clear; there is no benefit to chasing 99 or 100.

Two rules that keep it working

- **Keep warm-up running alongside real sending.** It is not a phase you graduate out of; turning it off mid-campaign is the fastest way to see scores slide.
- **Never run two warm-up tools on one mailbox.** Double warm-up does not warm faster; it confuses the reputation signal and can trigger the exact spam flags you are avoiding.

On SendKit, health scores are real and unfaked, and every mailbox warms on its own isolated IP, so nobody else's sending affects what your score is telling you.

Check your mailbox health scores

Open your mailboxes view and confirm every sending mailbox is at a health score of 95 or above.

[Check your health scores](#)